

Merchant Onboarding and Service Review Procedure

Document SOP-15 | Version 1.0 | Approved | Effective 2026-09-01

Owner: Operations Manager. Approval authority: Managing Director. Scope: Merchant Success Executive. Review due: 2027-09-01. Valid until: No scheduled expiry.

Purpose and application

Establish clear merchant service commitments and maintain an auditable record of onboarding, changes and issues.

Role mandate: Onboard merchants and manage service commitments without overriding controls. Reports to: Operations Manager. Department: Merchant Services. Delegated authority is limited to the steps below; independent financial or policy approval remains with the named approver.

4.1 Verify merchant onboarding

REQ-SOP-15-01 | Mandatory

The Merchant Success Executive must complete the approved merchant profile and verification checklist before activation. Missing verification evidence requires a hold and manager review.

Evidence: Verified merchant profile and activation checklist.

4.2 Record service terms

REQ-SOP-15-02 | Mandatory

The Merchant Success Executive must record agreed service zones, cutoffs, return conditions and billing terms in the approved agreement. Oral promises must not alter recorded terms.

Evidence: Approved agreement version.

4.3 Explain prohibited items

REQ-SOP-15-03 | Mandatory

The Merchant Success Executive must brief the merchant on the approved prohibited-item list and escalation route before the first shipment. Unlisted uncertain items require Operations Manager review.

Evidence: Merchant acknowledgement and any item review.

4.4 Coordinate first shipment

REQ-SOP-15-04 | Mandatory

The Merchant Success Executive must coordinate a supervised first-shipment check with Dispatch and confirm identifiers, labels and contacts before routine volume is accepted.

Evidence: First-shipment readiness record.

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4.5 Approve service changes

REQ-SOP-15-05 | Mandatory

The Merchant Success Executive must obtain Operations Manager approval before committing to exceptional service levels or changes affecting delivery capacity.

Evidence: Change request and capacity approval.

4.6 Review merchant issues

REQ-SOP-15-06 | Mandatory

The Merchant Success Executive must review open merchant issues at least weekly and record the accountable owner and next action for each unresolved issue.

Evidence: Weekly issue review.

4.7 Protect payment changes

REQ-SOP-15-07 | Mandatory

The Merchant Success Executive must refer requests to change settlement details to Finance verification and must not update bank details on an email instruction alone.

Evidence: Payment-change referral and verification outcome.

4.8 Share improvement insights

REQ-SOP-15-08 | Recommended

The Merchant Success Executive may provide a monthly service-improvement summary based on approved aggregated performance data.

Evidence: Optional merchant improvement summary.

Training and control

Employees learn the applicable clauses during Week 1 and complete a source-based knowledge check. Task performers demonstrate the relevant procedure before independent work. Mandatory knowledge checks require at least 80 percent; all safety and privacy critical steps must pass. The assessor records requirement IDs, evidence and the source version. An earlier operational deadline still applies. Questions and exceptions follow POL-01; related controls include POL-01, POL-03, POL-05, POL-06 and POL-09.